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Culture (OWC): [Gikuyu \(FL10\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Eastern Africa

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Section Title(S)

Grandparents on both sides • Mother's Relatives

When the grandparents are not living near the homesteads of their daughters or sons, the children pay frequent visits to their grandparents and stay with them for some time. Sometimes it becomes difficult to get the children to return to their parents homesteads, for they feel more free in playing and joking with their grandparents than they would with their own parents.

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Mother's Relatives

As we have seen that the behaviour pattern towards the father is extended to his brothers and sisters, in the same way that towards the mother is extended to her relatives. The important members of her family group, who enter into functions of the kinship system, are the father, mother, brother, and sister. Her mother and father, as stated above, treat their daughter's children with great respect and love.

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The mother's sister is called *tata*, the same as the father's sister, but the relation between her and the children of her sister is entirely different. She is looked upon by the children in the same way as their real mother. The affection and indulgence that she gives to the children and the sympathetic attitude towards them is even greater than that the children  17 can expect from their own mother. Children like to visit or to be visited by their aunt, and whenever such a visit is made it is always an occasion of rejoicing and feasting. The children of both sisters address one another as *moro* or *mware we tata* (son or daughter of my or our aunt), the behaviour pattern between them is almost like brothers and sisters.

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